



◀ THE TORRE DEL MANGIA TOWER SEEN FROM THE COURTYARD OF PALAZZO PUBBLICO

a uniquely English contribution to Gothic style—the hammer beam. The roof was constructed from 1393 on the orders of Richard II. It consists of a series of huge oak timbers projecting inward, from which pointed wooden arches spring out to span the hall. It is not merely technically remarkable, but it is also very decorative; for example, the projecting timbers are carved with oversized angels.

Sant'Antonio

Location Padua, Italy

The idiosyncrasies of Italian Gothic style are nowhere more obvious than in the vast, late 12th-century basilica of Sant'Antonio, which combines elements from at least three different and apparently incompatible styles—French, Lombard, and Byzantine. For example, the church's roof is crowded with domes, rising from huge drums, interspersed with a series of slim towers, all with lanterns. Unusually, both the transepts and the nave are marked by gables, and those on the nave are separated by hefty buttresses. The similarly gabled facade is more coherent: the entrance is flanked by pointed arches containing attenuated windows under an elegant Venetian arcade. The interior contains a riotous assembly of decorative styles, from the Gothic to the Baroque.

Palazzo Pubblico

Location Siena, Italy

Siena's Palazzo Pubblico, completed by 1344, is among the most impressive medieval structures in Italy. The palace forms an eloquent, self-confident statement of civic pride, built at a time when the rival city-states of Italy continually sought to outdo each other. Built out of bricks above a limestone ground floor, it comprises two distinct elements. The imposing

main body of the building, slightly concave though symmetrical, features a commanding four-story central block, its crenellated summit flanked by two three-story blocks. The central block has four bays, and the flanking blocks have three. To the right, a bell tower, the Torre del Mangia, soars 335 ft (102 m) high. Its elaborate limestone summit flares outward and is crowned by a further crenellated marble tower.

Ca d'Oro

Location Venice, Italy

The fantasy Gothic style of 15th-century Venice—a mixture of Gothic, Byzantine, and Arabic—is precisely captured by perhaps the most sumptuous residential building on the Grand Canal—the Ca d'Oro ("House of Gold"). The building was never completed: a three-bay wing, matching that on the right, was planned for its left-hand side. Nevertheless, what was built is remarkable, and would have been even more so when it was sheathed in gold leaf—hence the name. Constructed over three stories and a mezzanine, it features central bays flanked by windows with projecting

arcaded balconies. The building has three loggias—the largest is on the ground floor, and the upper two feature interlinked, pointed arches decorated with tracery. Across the top of the facade runs a line of spires of rhythmically varying height.

Coca Castle

Location Coca, Spain

Coca Castle, in central Spain, is one of the last and largest of Europe's medieval castles. Built from 1453, mostly using brick, it is also a striking example of Mudéjar architecture, which developed in Spain during and after the Christian reconquest. It saw buildings that essentially followed established Latin Christian forms but were executed with Moorish details. In the case of Coca Castle, this meant that the overall plan of the castle—with a massive moat; tower-studded outer walls; and, at its heart, a heavily defended strong point, or keep—echoed the form of castle-building developed during the Crusades. By contrast, the clusters of polygonal corner towers, sharply pointed at their bases and fluted at their summits, are completely Moorish.



▲ POLYGONAL AND SEMICIRCULAR TOWERS OF COCA CASTLE

Westminster Hall

Location London, England

Built for William II from 1097, Westminster Hall is the oldest surviving part of the Palace of Westminster (see p.178). Measuring 240 ft (73 m) long and 67 ft (20 m) wide, it was once the largest hall in Europe. However, the roof is its most remarkable feature. Its design is the most impressive example of